

Any robotic or automation product comprises two broad components, hardware and software. With our new manufacturing facility, Bot-Valley, we will be able to compete on cost and quality with regard to the hardware; traditionally, India is seen as a global powerhouse for software. For us, we see all robotic and automation products as a software product, and this has helped us to add some very distinct features to our products which are not provided by anyone in the world. Also, it has helped us to make the integration of our products with various customers smooth and easy.

Why do you believe in India as a major market for robotics?

Because we have been users of this technology ourselves, we know what it is actually capable of. However, it is also true that companies only invest in technologies when they are sure about the returns they are going to get in the future. What we do is we educate the customer, and this becomes easier for us as we have gone through the process ourselves.

Automation in India will never get justified as something that will replace human beings, which is very normal



Velocé

in countries like China and the USA. What is of prime importance in India is how effectively you can use this space because of the costs involved—increased land cost, and also building a facility in India is costlier than in the USA and it is equivalent to that of Europe. Therefore, if you can save on the land or the building cost, that can fund the automation. That is exactly what we educate our customers about.

Second, at scales that the likes of Asian Paints, Flipkart, Amazon, Haldiram, and Pepsico operate, you cannot operate manually. It is not possible to do so without making mistakes. Automation, on such huge scales, can help these companies and the likes of them to offer reliability to their customers. In short, automation is the answer to the scale of operations. There was a time when big companies used to follow the cartons route, then came the packets route, and now we have also started talking about the pieces route. This is where automation can really help.

Third, we design the solution and show them how effectively it can work and then leave it to their decision makers.

Typically, one believes that robots will take more space than humans, but you are saying that they can reduce the need for land! Can you explain how?

Be it e-commerce, food retail, or manufacturing giants, the location of their warehousing facilities is one of the pivotal pillars for their operational excellence and supply chain planning. Ideally, warehouses need to be close to the cities to reduce the transit time for goods. However, close-by land often comes with higher rentals. An optimal solution in such cases of higher rentals is to utilise the height of the warehouse in an efficient manner. We focus on cubic space utilisation of a warehouse. Flying high does make sense if you intend to utilise the space of the warehouse efficiently. For this, it is essential that you equip yourselves with Cruiser (Pallet Shuttle), Quadron (Carton Shuttle), or Multi-Pro (ASRS) which assists in increasing the warehouse space through vertical stacking of the inventory. Addverb is the lead-



JK Paper, Surat ASRS



Zippy 40 Renders

ing Pallet Shuttle solution provider for cubic feet utilisation via dense racking in a warehouse.

Can you explain a bit more in detail for the advantage of senior business decision makers how the expertise in software makes investment in your robots a smarter decision than the ones you compete with?

For any robotic or automation solution to be successful, there are three factors that need to be considered:

Robustness of product. This refers to the product hardware quality and is required to ensure that the product doesn't fail in its hardware. This is mostly a one-time process and is ensured through a stringent quality control. Once a hardware is installed, it typically runs for a long time with scheduled maintenance.

Ease of integration. Ease of integration with other automation solutions and with existing enterprise resource planning (ERP) systems is important and often determines the timelines of the project. Ability to integrate with different systems and interfaces is a must. A product in warehouse or factory automation does not act alone, it needs to accommodate the changing nature of demand and SKUs. Tasks like scheduling or prioritising